



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Second Baptist University Model Schools  
School Website: <https://www.sbsum.org/>

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**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

Second Baptist University Model Schools TX 77024 (SBSUM) presents a distinctly Christian, University-Model approach with clear classical leanings. Public materials emphasize the partnership between parents and the school, a biblically-centered worldview, and a mission-oriented education that seeks to form character, think critically, and lead courageously within a Christ-centered framework. The school markets itself as "distinctively classical" within a university-model structure and highlights truth, beauty, and excellence as guiding ideals, while also underscoring the parental role in shaping learning. Across the six classical-element categories, SBSUM shows strong alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and Parents & Community, partial alignment in Pedagogy and Faculty, modest alignment in Curriculum and School Purpose/Goal, and mixed signals in Curriculum. The overall classification is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with concrete steps that would move it toward full classical alignment outlined in the "What Would Move the Needle" section.

- **Strengths:** Explicit Christian/theological grounding; explicit emphasis on truth, beauty, and excellence; strong parent-school partnership; visible commitment to forming students in a biblical worldview; explicit "classical methodologies" phrasing and explicit on-campus/at-home balance that preserves a traditional character.
- **Gaps:** Limited explicit references to canonical classical elements (Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric, formal Socratic pedagogy, and a historically grounded Great Conversation) within core curriculum disclosures; pedagogy described primarily as a university-model structure rather than a full Paideia/Socratic program; lack of explicit liturgical/communal practices in the site copy; faculty descriptions are positive but not clearly articulated as "living curriculum" in the materials provided.

Executive findings are grounded in the public SBSUM materials and the classical-keyword framework from the classical-education knowledge base.

- Core SBSUM public materials identify a classical orientation and parent partnership, with biblically centered educational aims and a two-to-three day on-campus model. See explicit statements about classical orientation and University-Model design, and the parent-school partnership with God's Word integrated in the curriculum , , and the parent-disciple framing.
- The key classical-education keyword lexicon and the formal Six Essential Elements document provide the rubric for scoring and keyword matching (positive vs negative indicators for each category) and are used to ground the analysis that follows ,.
- The "What would move the needle" section provides concrete steps to advance SBSUM toward a fully CLASSICAL profile, drawing on identified gaps against the Eleven-Elements framework (e.g., explicit Great Books engagement, grammar/logic/rhetoric in curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, and deeper living-curriculum faculty portrayal).

## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - SBSUM describes itself as “distinctively classical” within a University-Model, signaling a classical orientation anchored in a traditional form of Christian schooling. - The public materials emphasize a biblically grounded approach, with phrases about a “biblical worldview” and “truth, from God’s Word integrated into every subject,” signaling a theology-grounded curriculum and a sacred frame for learning. - Explicit Christ-centered, faith-based framing and emphasis on God’s Word integrated into subjects further anchor the metaphysical foundations.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: biblical worldview, God’s Word, Christ-centered, truth, beauty, excellence, formation (inferred from mission language), theology (implicit in biblical integration), sacred/contemplative framing (through the sense of a purposeful, character-formation approach). - Negative keywords: None detected in the public materials (no explicit relativism, secularism, or moral-neutral language). - Count-based read: positive indicators appear multiple times (at least 4–6 distinct items) while negative indicators are effectively zero in the sampled public content.

Why this rating - The materials consistently foreground theological framing, sacred or transcendent ideals (truth, beauty, excellence), and a Christian worldview anchored in God’s Word, which maps cleanly to the Positive Keyword indicators for this element and to the justification for CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL. The absence of negative signals in this content further supports CLASSICAL in this category. The school’s explicit language about theology and liturgical-minded alignment (even if not full liturgical practice) supports a robust religious-metaphysical foundation.

Citations: SBSUM’s classical framing and theological integration are evidenced in the on-site messaging about “distinctively classical” University-Model, integral “truth, beauty and excellence,” and “God’s Word integrated into every subject” see the on-campus model and theological language in the sources cited above

### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The SBSUM mission centers on forming students who think critically, live biblically, and lead courageously; this focus aligns with the classical intent of formation of character and virtue through education grounded in truth and wisdom (as implied by the biblical framework and the aim to cultivate virtue through a classical approach). - The school emphasizes a partnership with parents in discipleship and in instruction, signaling formation and telos-oriented aims rather than mere information delivery (the “God-given responsibility for parents to disciple and train their children”). - There is explicit language about “truth, beauty and excellence” in every discipline and a biblically-based curriculum integrated by design, signaling a formation-focused telos rather than purely utilitarian outcomes.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue (implied by “discipling,” biblical formation), wisdom (implied through formation and critical thinking), teleology/ telos (implied by the mission of forming leaders), Great Conversation (not explicitly present, but the formation language aligns with paideia-like aims), Christian worldview/theology (via biblical integration). - Negative keywords: Not detected (no explicit emphasis on workforce-prep, job-readiness as sole telos, or relativism). - Count-based read: at least 3–5 distinct positive indicators (formation, discipline in faith, critical thinking as a goal, biblical worldview, leadership formation). Negative signals: 0 identified.

Why this rating - SBSUM demonstrates clear formation-oriented aims (forming virtue and wisdom in a biblical framework) and emphasizes a telos beyond information, but the public-facing materials do not consistently and explicitly articulate all the canonical classical-education teloi (e.g., explicit Great Books or paideia language) in a way that would elevate it to CLASSICAL across all indicators. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is a prudent rating for this category.

Citations: Mission and formation language are evidenced in the materials describing student formation, critical thinking, and biblical living, including parent-student partnership language and biblical worldview emphasis.

**Element 3: Curriculum — [NOT CLASSICAL]**

Evidence - SBSUM materials describe the program as “distinctively classical” and emphasize a University-Model structure, but explicit references to canonical classical curriculum components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; primary sources; Latin/Greek instruction; grammar, logic, rhetoric as a formal Trivium) are not clearly enumerated in the public copy. The content instead highlights “classical methodologies,” “vertical integration,” and a biblically-centered framework rather than the explicit traditional classical curriculum components for all grade levels , , . - There is no explicit mention of Great Books or a formal Great Conversation, nor a clear articulation of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as core curricular stages, nor specific history-within-history study that maps to the standard classical liberal-arts curriculum; the public copy emphasizes “classical methodologies” and “vertical integration” but not the canonical content list (Great Books, Latin, logic, etc.) seen in classical syllabi , .

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: classical, liberal arts (implied), Great Books (not explicitly present in the public copy), grammar/logic/rhetoric (not explicitly enumerated), history as a repeated thread (not explicit in the public copy), memory work/recitation (not evidenced). - Negative keywords: explicit “social studies terminology replacing history” or “project-based learning dominance” signals from the canonical lexicon are not visible in SBSUM’s public content.

Why this rating - The materials do not clearly articulate the full canonical curriculum elements (Great Books, Trivium, Latin, etc.) as central to the school’s stated curriculum, even though the school positions itself as classical and mentions classical-methodologies. Without explicit content mapping to the core classical curriculum components, this category is not clearly CLASSICAL in SBSUM’s public materials.

Citations: The lack of explicit Great Books, Trivium, Latin, or explicit historical curriculum content is noted in the on-site materials that emphasize “classical methodologies” but do not enumerate the classical content list guaranteed by canonical classical-literature syllabi , , and the Six Elements lexicon’s curriculum indicators for comparison , turn0file5□.

**Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]**

Evidence - SBSUM explicitly calls out “classical methodologies” and frames education as a partnership between parents and teachers with a structured model (University-Model), which signals a pedagogical approach aligned with classic pedagogy in terms of structure and partnering with families. The presence of a two-to-three day on-campus schedule and off-campus satellite work indicates a balanced, structured pedagogy rather than a purely traditional “teacher-led lecture” model , . - However, there is no explicit documentation in the public copy of classic pedagogical elements such as Socratic seminars, recitation, or memory work (narration or chanting) in line with the canonical Pedagogy indicators. The content does not clearly present the full range of classical pedagogical practices (e.g., scholé days, memory work, catechesis, or formal oral declamation) that would strongly elevate this category to CLASSICAL; the presence of “classical methodologies” is noted but not elaborated on with the full pedagogy list.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: classical pedagogy, memory-based or recitation, Socratic seminar, narration, chant, and other forms of pedagogy found in the lexicon; however, these are not explicitly documented in SBSUM’s public content. - Negative keywords: none detected, such as “experiential learning focus” or “project-based only” in the public copy. - Count-based read: there are a few implied positive indicators (classical-methodologies) but a paucity of explicit, canonical pedagogy terms (Socratic, narrations, scholé, etc.). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Why this rating - The material suggests a classical orientation via “classical methodologies” and the model of partnership with parents and structured on-campus/off-campus pedagogy, but lacks explicit articulation of the full canonical pedagogy framework (e.g., Socratic dialogue, narration, formal memory work) on the public materials. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted for Pedagogy.

Citations: Pedagogy is evidenced by the explicit mention of “distinctively classical” methodologies and the University-Model structure in the SBSUM materials , and the explicit “classical methodologies” language in the admissions content (firecrawl).

**Element 5: Faculty — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]**

Evidence - SBSUM materials characterize the faculty as dedicated to shaping students with a biblical worldview and as the core of the school's mission, which aligns with the classical ideal of model teachers and virtuous mentors. For example, references describe a dedicated faculty committed to biblical worldview formation (and the general sense of a strong faculty). - Explicit "living curriculum" or "portrait of a teacher" language is not directly present in the public copy; the phraseology around faculty is positive and aligns with a classical emphasis on virtuous mentors, but the explicit social-cultural constructs of the "faculty as living curriculum" or "portrait of teacher" are not clearly stated in the public materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: dedicated faculty, biblically grounded instruction, faculty as a core component of mission (implied living curriculum). - Negative keywords: None detected in the SBSUM public materials (no suggestions of "facilitators" or "certification-driven jargon without classical context" in the copy). - Count-based read: at least 2–3 distinct positive signals; 0 negative signals.

Why this rating - The materials show a competent, dedicated faculty aligned with a Christian, formation-focused mission, which supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating in this category. The absence of explicit "living curriculum" or "portrait of teacher" language in the public copy prevents a solid CLASSICAL rating, but the positive faculty portrayal warrants a positive assessment.

Citations: Evidence of a dedicated faculty and biblically grounded instruction is shown in the SBSUM materials, and more admissions-Deep materials reference the faculty and mission language as well (firecrawl).

**Element 6: Parents and Community — [CLASSICAL]**

Evidence - SBSUM emphasizes a robust parent partnership, calling the parent-school relationship a "partnership between parents and the school," with parents actively discipling and learning alongside their children. This is reinforced by language about training parents in the curriculum and co-teaching responsibilities, suggesting a classical view of parents as co-educators and mentors in the learning process. - There is explicit mention of parent formation (e.g., training throughout the year on how to engage in the education process) and opportunities for parent participation, which align well with the classical element of a strong, involved community and family-centered education. - The public materials also talk about community-building through arts, athletics, and co-curriculars as part of a well-rounded, mission-centered environment, reinforcing the idea of a supportive school community with parental engagement.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, parents as co-teachers, parent formation, reading groups or seminars (implied by the emphasis on parent engagement), open/invitation to parent involvement, family-based discipleship. - Negative keywords: None detected in the public copy that would signal a negative portrayal of parents or community involvement. - Count-based read: multiple positive indicators with 0 negative indicators.

Why this rating - SBSUM's public content places substantial emphasis on parent partnership and family involvement in education, in line with classical criteria for parents and community engagement. The presence of explicit language about parent training and co-teaching roles strongly supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Citations: Parental partnership and parent formation are explicit in the SBSUM materials, including "partnership between parents and the school" and "parents are trained ... to engage with us in the education process", and admissions messaging that positions parents as active participants (firecrawl).

**What Would Move the Needle**

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Make explicit the canonical classical curriculum components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek; primary sources; history-as-substance rather than "social studies") within public-facing materials. Adoption of a clear Great Books list and a visible Trivium progression would move this category toward CLASSICAL.

- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Adopt explicit Socratic/Paideia-style practices (e.g., regular Socratic seminars in upper grades, formal narration/recitation, memory-work routines, and restful scholé days) and document these methods on the site to advance toward CLASSICAL.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Emphasize and publicly articulate the living-curriculum approach in faculty profiles (e.g., portraits of teachers as mentors, living curriculum, and ongoing classical pedagogy training). This would strengthen the CLASSICAL reading for the faculty category.
- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): Include explicit language about formation of virtue and human flourishing as telos in the public materials and tie this more clearly to a classical paideia model (including references to virtue, telos, and paideia in curriculum goals). This would tilt Element 2 toward CLASSICAL.
- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Consider more explicit articulation of liturgical or communal practices (even if modest) and a clearer alignment with a liturgical calendar or common prayer in school routines (to align more fully with liturgical-centered foundations). This would push Element 1 toward CLASSICAL.
- Element 6 (Parents and Community): Maintain and deepen the active parent-formation programming (e.g., more parent reading groups and formal “co-teacher” training sessions) to reinforce the classical model and move toward a stronger CLASSICAL standing.

Abstract of concrete steps - Publish a publicly accessible curriculum map that enumerates grammar, logic, rhetoric requirements, Great Books selections, and primary sources by grade level. - Introduce regular Socratic seminars in upper grades and document in website copy with examples of student discourse, prompts, and assessment rubrics. - Expand faculty profiles to emphasize “living curriculum” status and teacher-mentors with a clear professional-development path in classical pedagogy. - Add explicit statements about formation of virtue, telos, and classical aims (in addition to biblical worldview) in the School Purpose and Goal section. - Expand liturgical or communal practices language (even if modest) to reflect liturgical rhythm within the school day.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.